

Human-Centered Robot Learning and Interaction

HumanRLI 2026

Toward Reliable and Scalable Autonomy in Human Environments

November 12, 2026 Austin, Texas, USA In-person

Robot learning has made rapid progress on dexterous manipulation, locomotion, navigation, and increasingly general vision-language-action models. Yet real-world deployment means operating **in human environments and around humans** — homes, hospitals, offices, warehouses, public spaces — where people are not only end-users but also **collaborators, supervisors, demonstrators, and bystanders**. This workshop asks how we translate lab-scale demonstrations into systems **reliable enough to be trusted** and **scalable enough to deploy** across diverse users, tasks, and settings.

• Call for Papers — Representative Topics

- 1 Learning from Human Data**
Scalable interaction data · demonstrations, corrections, preferences · continual learning from feedback · privacy, consent, effort
- 2 Human-Aware Foundation Models**
Grounding VLA models in contact and social norms · human attention, intent, mental states · personalization and preference alignment
- 3 Reliability, Safety, Evaluation**
Benchmarks beyond task success · robustness to clutter, interruptions, novice users · failure detection, recovery, graceful handover
- 4 Long-Horizon Interaction**
Turn-taking, intent inference, interaction repair · multi-session memory · field studies in homes, hospitals, warehouses

• Important Dates

Submissions Open **Sep 16, 2026**Deadline **Oct 9, 2026**Notification **TBD**Camera Ready **TBD**Workshop Day **Nov 12, 2026**

Deadline 11:59 PM Anywhere on Earth (AoE)

Invited Speakers



Harold Soh
NUS

Trust-aware HRI; tactile perception; learning from feedback



Andreea Bobu
MIT

Representations of human intent; preference alignment



Jakob Thumm
Stanford University

Provably safe human-robot collaboration; personalization



Masha Itkina
Toyota Research Institute

Trustworthy learning under uncertainty; robot evaluation

Program (Half Day)

0:00 Opening & live challenge poll

2:00 Poster & live-demo session

3:15 Contributed spotlight talks

0:15 Invited talks — four 20-min talks + Q&A

2:40 Fishbowl discussion

3:45 Closing synthesis & roadmap

Organizing Committee



Jiachen Li
Georgia Tech



Jing Liang
Stanford



Yao Feng
StarWith



Zehao Wang
Georgia Tech



Zhangchen Ye
Tsinghua



Zhiwen Fan
Texas A&M



Andrea Bajcsy
CMU



Qi Chen
Toyota InfoTech



Yongkang Liu
Toyota InfoTech



Akin Sisbot
Toyota InfoTech



Julian Nubert
Flexion Robotics



Korrawe Karunratanakul
Flexion Robotics

Submit on OpenReview · Non-archival · Double-blind · Best Paper Award

8 pages of main text, excluding references and appendices · CoRL template
openreview.net/group?id=robot-learning.org/CoRL/2026/Workshop/HumanRLI

Submit →
by Oct 9, 2026